

Pablo M. Guzmán Lizardo

PhD Economist at Stanford University
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SUMMARY

PhD Economist (Political Economics Track; Stanford GSB) specializing in public finance, public economics and development economics. Five years of experience in property taxation and VAT research in developing economies across Sub-Saharan Africa and the Western Hemisphere. My research combines large-scale randomized controlled trials with modern econometric, machine learning, and survey methods to generate credible causal evidence on tax compliance. My work has influenced tax policy in local governments in Sierra Leone and led to ongoing national scale-up efforts. I have co-authored projects securing over \$300,000 in external grants. Track record of building productive collaborations across governments, civil society, and international partners. Languages: English (bilingual), Spanish (native), Portuguese (advanced), French (advanced).

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Poverty, Violence, and Governance Lab, *Stanford University* 2026-Present
Postdoctoral Research Fellow

EDUCATION

Stanford University, *PhD in Political Economics* 2021-2026
Fields: Public Finance, Public Economics, Development Economics.
Committee: Katherine Casey (primary), Caroline Hoxby, Beatriz Magaloni-Kerpel, Juan Carlos Suárez Serrato, Gregory Martin.

McGill University, *B.A. Economics and B.A. Political Science* 2017-2021
First Class Honours in Political Science, First Class Honours in Economics, Minor Concentration in Mathematics. Dean's Honour List.

RESEARCH PAPERS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

Unlocking Fiscal Capacity: Experimental Evidence from Sierra Leone ([JMP Latest draft](#))

Co-authored with Wilson Prichard and Niccolò Meriggi

We conduct a factorial field experiment within a property tax reform in Kenema City, Sierra Leone, evaluating two interventions. The first is an enforcement program involving initial notices, court hearings chaired by traditional chiefs, and penalties. The second is a civic campaign where religious authorities motivated compliance through door-to-door visits using normative appeals. Enforcement increases the compliance rate by 53.4 ppts, 16 times the average in the prior literature, and religious visits add 4.9 ppts. Both interventions generate spillovers to neighboring property owners. Survey data on over 6,000 property owners documents improvements in taxpayers' perceived credibility of enforcement, peer compliance expectations, willingness to comply, and legitimacy of the tax.

Strategic Delivery of Information about Tax Enforcement

Together with Wilson Prichard and Niccolò Meriggi

We evaluate how information about tax enforcement transmits across the city of Kenema, Sierra Leone, and leads to compliance. Working with the Sierra Leone Association of Journalists and the Kenema City Council, we deliver journalistic pamphlets about an ongoing enforcement program to property tax defaulters using a Saturation Experimental Design, varying the share of defaulters receiving pamphlets across city regions (0%, 40%, and 80%). Directly receiving the pamphlet increases compliance by 10 p.p. in low-saturation regions and 12 p.p. in high-saturation regions. Living in a high-saturation cluster increases compliance by over 5 p.p. even without direct receipt.

Mapping Attitudes Towards Taxation in Sierra Leone

Together with Wilson Prichard and Niccolò Meriggi

We track the evolution of tax attitudes among property owners in Kenema, Sierra Leone, across two city-wide enforcement campaigns (November 2024 and November 2025). After each campaign, respondents report increased beliefs that peers will comply and that the government will enforce, alongside higher willingness to comply and greater acceptance of tax legitimacy. However, while satisfaction with the local government rose after the first campaign, it fell substantially after the second, suggesting enforcement raises both compliance and performance expectations.

Impact of Militarized Policing in Dominican Republic

Through a collaboration with the Dominican Ministry of Defense, I construct an original granular panel dataset tracking all crime incidents and police-military patrols in the Dominican Republic for January–June 2023 and estimate the effect of mixed patrols on crime. Mixed patrols reduce crime incidence in a neighborhood during the week after an intervention, with no evidence of spillovers to neighboring areas.

Compliance Spillovers of VAT E-invoicing Through Supply Chain Networks

In this early project, I evaluate the determinants of VAT compliance in Dominican Republic, exploiting historical variation in VAT exemptions across industries and the staggered rollout of a national e-invoicing system to study compliance determinants and supply chain spillovers across firm networks.

AWARDS AND RESEARCH GRANTS

International Growth Centre Full Research Grant, £75,000	2024
Local Government Revenue Initiative Grant, €188,664	2024
Local Government Revenue Initiative Grant, USD \$51,165	2024
International Growth Centre Small Projects Fund, £19,000	2024
Charles William Snyder Memorial Scholarship	2020
McGill University Faculty of Arts' Dean Honour List	2018-2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business, Course Assistant	Winter 2025
POLECON 231: Strategy Beyond Markets. Assisted with leading class activities, grading assignments, and providing support to MBA students.	

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2027: AEA Annual Meeting (Upcoming).

2026: Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), NOVAFRICA Conference on Economic Development (Invited), ZEW Public Finance Conference, Symposium on Economic Experiments in Developing Countries (Invited), American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (Upcoming, Poster Session), National Tax Association Annual Conference on Taxation (Upcoming), 8th World Bank/ODI Global/IFS Public Finance Conference (Upcoming).

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY SERVICE

DevPEC, Conference Co-Organizer

April 2024

Co-organized the 2024 edition of the student-led Development and Political Economics Conference (DevPEC), a collaboration between Stanford University and UC Berkeley's Economics Departments.

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Languages: English (Bilingual), Spanish (Native), Portuguese (Advanced), French (Advanced), Sierra Leonean Krio (Beginner).

Programming and Statistical Packages: R, Python, Stata, SPSS, SQL.

Citizenship: Dominican Republic.

REFERENCES

Professor Katherine Casey

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Main academic advisor

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Professor Caroline Hoxby

Stanford Department of Economics

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Professor Beatriz Magaloni-Kerpel

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Professor Wilson Prichard

Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy

Co-author and policy collaborator

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